

Commitment to singlehood

- One's intent to persist in singlehood, including a psychological attachment and a long orientation toward singlehood
- Investment Model Scale for Singles (IMS-S) was developed to measure commitment to singlehood (Beauparlant et al., 2023)
- Singlehood experiences tend to depend on gender (e.g., female vs male; Apostolou et al., 2020; Adamczyk et al., 2016)
- Thus, there may be gender differences in commitment to singlehood**
- Before testing gender differences, we test for **measurement invariance** (Luong & Flake, 2021) to ensure any observed differences would reflect true differences (vs. measurement biases)

METHOD

- $N = 156$ single participants
- 84 Men & 72 Women
- $M_{Age} = 34.17$ years (range: 18-72)
- Majority were white & heterosexual
- Collected from Prolific in Fall 2024

Measures

- 13-item IMS-S to assess singlehood satisfaction, alternatives to singlehood, investment, and commitment
- 1 item to assess gender



Table 1. Factor Loadings from an Exploratory Factor Analysis

Items	Factor 1	Factor 2	Factor 3	Factor 4
1. I feel satisfied with being single. (S)	0.85	0.06	0.43	0.06
2. Being single is much better than others' relationships. (S)	0.73	-0.17	0.48	0.08
3. Being single is close to ideal. (S)	0.92	-0.14	0.51	0.21
4. The people I might become involved with are very appealing. (A)	-0.21	0.76	-0.17	-0.003
5. If I were not single, I would do fine— there are appealing people I could date. (A)	-0.07	0.68	-0.11	-0.09
6. For me, being in a relationship would be an attractive alternative to being single. (A)	-0.81	0.37	-0.36	-0.21
7. I have put a great deal into my single lifestyle that I would lose if I were to start a relationship. (I)	0.60	-0.23	0.85	0.26
8. Many aspects of my life have become linked to being single (recreational activities, etc.), and I would lose all of this if I were to start a relationship with someone. (I)	0.50	-0.25	0.79	0.32
9. My relationships with friends and family members would be complicated if I were to start dating someone (e.g., being single is an important part of my friendships). (I)	0.24	-0.03	0.57	0.01
10. I am committed to being single. (C)	0.90	-0.25	0.58	0.68
11. I feel very attached to being single— very strongly linked to my single lifestyle. (C)	0.82	-0.24	0.66	0.27
12. I am oriented toward the long-term future of being single (e.g., I imagine being single several years from now). (C)	0.80	-0.42	0.54	0.31
13. I intend to stay single. (C)	0.86	-0.31	0.50	0.30

Note. Satisfaction items = S, Alternatives items = A, Investment items = I, Commitment items = C; **Bolded** = loading ≥ 0.40 ; **Red** = loaded unexpectedly, **Blue** = loaded as expected

Table 2. Measurement Invariance Model Fit Indices

Model Type	χ^2	df	p	CFI	RMSEA	SRMR	ΔCFI	$\Delta RMSEA$	$\Delta SRMR$
Configural	14.31	4	0.006	0.98	0.18	0.02			
Weak	23.19	8	0.003	0.97	0.16	0.08	0.01	0.02	0.06
Strong	85.48	13	0.000	0.85	0.27	0.31	0.12	0.11	0.23
Strict	92.75	17	0.000	0.84	0.24	0.30	0.01	0.03	0.01

Note. Bolded models met decision criteria (see right panel for details); Δ = change

Analysis Plan

- Four-factor Confirmatory Factor Analysis of the IMS-S
- Measurement Invariance testing:
 - Configural (same factor structure)
 - Weak (equal factor loadings)
 - Strong (equal intercepts)
 - Strict (equal residuals)

Decision Criteria

- CFI $> .90$, RMSEA $< .06$, SRMR $< .08$
- Small changes (e.g., $\Delta CFI \leq .005$; $\Delta RMSEA \geq .010$) support stricter invariance (Chen, 2007)

PRELIMINARY RESULTS

- A CFA suggested the theorized 4-factor solution did not fit well (Table 1)
- A follow-up EFA suggested a 3-factor solution
- Preliminary invariance testing with four commitment items only suggested configural invariance (Table 2)

DISCUSSION

- The importance of specific items contributing to the latent variable, commitment, differ across gender
- These results are based on a small sample. We pre-registered two additional samples to be collected to ensure power and samples will be combined for final analyses.
- Nevertheless, if the final results are consistent, this measure cannot test gender differences in commitment